

GREGG WILLIAMS

Gregg Williams Masters an Unknown Links

His 86 was the second-lowest gross round of the 45 he has played in TEG, and nobody else in the field broke 88.

Gregg Williams produced the round of the day at Prince's Golf Club on the Friday of TEG 2020. He scored 41 points off a gross 86. The best anyone else managed was 37. In this company, four points is not a margin. It is a different postcode. It also stands as the second-lowest gross round of his 45 TEG rounds.

The round turned on the Dunes and Himalayas holes 11 to 13. Three straight pars, one of them on the par-4 13th, the third-hardest hole on the course. Nine

points in a row. He then kept it going through 15 and 16, two more clean holes without a gross shot dropped. A par at the par-5 15th, the hardest hole at Prince's, and another at the par-3 16th. It was less a charge than a man quietly filing paperwork while the building burned around him.

The round did little to disturb the wider picture. Jon Baker remained leader of both the 2020 TEG Trophy and the TEG Green Jacket. Williams's score did, however, cut the Trophy gap at the top from six shots to one.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Gregg WILLIAMS (41 pts)
TROPHY LEAD Jon BAKER, 1 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD Jon BAKER, 7 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
GW 41 DM 37 JB 36 AB 34 JP 28
ROUND GROSS
GW +14 JB +16 DM +17 AB +27 JP +33

AFTER R2 · TROPHY
JB 75 GW 74 DM 68 AB 65 JP 56
AFTER R2 · GREEN JACKET
JB +29 GW +36 DM +39 AB +57 JP +69

TROPHY

Jon Baker Reclaims It at Eighteen

The TEG 13 Green Jacket margin also narrowed, from nine strokes to seven, with Gregg Williams replacing David Mullin as the man in second.

Jon Baker had led the 2020 TEG 13 Trophy since round one, hole two. That is 32 holes across two rounds at Prince's - Dunes / Himalayas, held with the calm of a man who assumed the arrangement was permanent. It ended at the 16th of round two. Gregg Williams had already squared the race at the 15th, then nudged in front with a par at the hardest hole on the course.

Baker's exile lasted two holes. He played both without dropping a gross shot and birdied the 18th, one of the easier finishing holes, to take the lead back outright. One point clear heading into the rest of the tournament. Earlier he had steadied himself with a birdie at the 6th, halting a bogey-double bogey slide before it acquired opinions of its own.

Elsewhere, David Mullin ran up a quadruple bogey at the 9th, which the leaderboard absorbed without comment. But the day belonged to Baker. After round two he led both the Trophy and the Green Jacket, his overnight cushion in the latter having grown to seven.

WOODEN SPOON

John Patterson's Three Good Holes

The 10th, 11th and 12th brought him nine points; the rest of Prince's brought him nineteen.

John Patterson's second round at Prince's opened with a quadruple-bogey 8 and closed with a quadruple-bogey 8. Between those two identical monuments he assembled 28 points and a gross 105.

The trouble arrived on schedule. The quad at the 1st set the tone, and by the 4th he had bled 11 shots in four holes without a single net par to his name. The 5th and 6th steadied him. Holes 7 and 8 brought his best spell of the round, two pars in a row with nothing dropped. A three-hole run from the 10th added 9 points, built on pars at 10 and 12 either side of a bogey at the par-5 11th. For roughly half an hour, John Patterson was playing golf.

Then holes 13 to 15 cost him eight shots, including a triple bogey at the 15th, the hardest hole on the course. The 17th supplied the second 8, arriving like a debt collector who had always known the address. He remains anchored at the foot of the 2020 Wooden Spoon table, where the furniture has begun to take his shape.

ALEX BAKER

Five Doubles to Finish for Alex Baker

Nine points across the 3rd, 4th and 5th suggested one kind of afternoon; the last five holes delivered quite another.

At Prince's Golf Club's Dunes/Himalayas course on Friday, Alex Baker's second round lurched about for a while and then simply stopped working. He parred the 3rd, bogeyed the 4th and 5th, and took 9 stableford points from that stretch. From the 10th to the 12th he gave back 7 shots, a triple bogey and two doubles.

The finish was something else. Five consecutive double bogeys from the 14th through the 18th, ten gross shots dropped in ten holes' worth of golf compressed into five. It began with a double on the par-3 14th, one of the easier holes out there. It included another on the par-5 15th, Prince's hardest hole by stroke index. Two more followed at the 17th and 18th. Five doubles in a row is not a collapse. It is a rhythm. It left his gross for the day at 99, the only figure recorded for him at the course so far this TEG.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 13, Round 2